
PROTOCOL

1. For each sample, **top-label a PCR tube** with the name indicated on the labsheet.
2. Set up each sample, in order:
 - 8 loading dye (tube marked **LOAD**)
 - 3 PCR product
 - **LOAD has to be fresh — made within 2 days.** The stain does not keep. If it is older, make a new aliquot: **100 μ L blue juice + 1 μ L dye** in an Eppendorf tube, labelled **LOAD**.
 - **Marker, one per section:** 8 μ L loading dye into a tube of marker (yellow).
3. **Mix, quick spin.**
4. Cut a **1% gel slab** with enough wells for all samples, the marker, and a few spare.
5. Place it in the rig, fill with **1 $\times$ TAE** to just cover it, and brace it with the plastic wedge.
6. Load **9 μ L** per well with a P20, in labsheet order.
7. Lid and leads on: **run to red** — load at the black end.
8. Run at **175 V** for about **10 min. Do not set a timer and walk away** — check every minute or so and stop when the blue front is **2/3–3/4 down the gel**.
9. Image it on the imager **through the orange filter**, with a label strip above the gel. Name the file by date and time, and upload it.